**Info bits**

Tamil Nadu is a leading state endowed with rich fishery resources from Marine, Inland and Coastal Aquaculture. The marine fisheries potential of the state is estimated at 0.719 million tonnes. The inland fishery resources have a potential to yield 4.5 lakh metric tonnes of fishes. Tamilnadu ranks sixth among the maritime states in coastal farming.

**Marine water aquaculture:** The cultivation of aquatic organisms is in sea water. This is also referred as Mariculture or Sea farming. Culture of organisms is carried out along the sea coast (inshore area) and in deep sea. Organisms like shrimps (marine prawns), pearl oysters, edible oysters, mussels and fin fishes like salmons, sea bass, milk fishes and mullets are cultured in marine water.

### 23.10.2 Prospects of Aquaculture

Aquaculture has become the fastest growing food producing sector to meet the demands of food and nutrition to the growing population through increased production from aquatic food resources. It aims at blue revolution. It is a major source of export and foreign exchange earnings for the country. It generates employment through fish farming in rural and under developed area.

## 23.11 Pisciculture

Pisciculture or Fish culture is the process of breeding and rearing of fishes in ponds, reservoirs (dams), lakes, rivers and paddy fields. It is the farming of economically important fishes under controlled conditions.

### 23.11.1 Types of Fish Culture

**Extensive fish culture**: Culture of fishes in large areas with low stocking density and natural feeding.

**Intensive fish culture**: Culture of fishes in small areas with high stocking density and providing artificial feed to increase production.

**Info bits**

The Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI) was established by the Government of India in 1947 at Cochin, Kerala State. Its main focus is on marine fisheries landings, research on taxonomy and bioeconomic characteristics of marine organisms.

The Central Institute of Brackish Water Aquaculture (CIBA) was established in 1987 with its headquarters at Chennai. The objective of CIBA is management of sustainable culture system for fin fish and shell fish in brackish water. CIBA assists small aquafarmers in fin fish and shrimp farming by providing sustainable modern technologies.

**Monoculture**: It is the culture of single type of fish in a water body. It is also called mono species culture.

**Polyculture**: It is the culture of more than one type of fish in a water body. It is also called composite fish culture.

**Integrated fish farming**: It is the culture of fishes along with agricultural crops or animal husbandry farming. Rearing of fish along with paddy, poultry, cattle, pig and ducks.

### 23.11.2 Types of Ponds for Fish Culture

Fish farm requires different types of pond for the various developmental stages of fish growth. They are given below:

**Breeding pond**: Healthy and sexually mature male and female fishes are collected and introduced in this pond for breeding. The eggs released by the female are fertilized by the sperm and fertilized eggs float in water as frothy mass.

**Hatching pits:** The fertilized eggs are transferred to hatching pits or hatching hapas for hatching.



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